

Storm Split

A BTD6-shaped tower defense for Fortnite Creative, where the towers are NPCs wearing real Fortnite outfits and your weapon is the hero — it grants your ability and levels on two tracks, one per match and one that never resets.

Team of **2**Co-op **2–4**, shared cashPlayable slice: **~6 weeks**Engine: **UEFN + Verse**

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01 — THE PITCH

Storm husks walk a track. You stop them.

Every mechanic below has a one-to-one UEFN feature behind it. Nothing here needs a system Epic hasn't shipped.

Two to four players defend a fixed track. Husks spawn at one end and walk toward the exit; every one that reaches it costs a life. You spend shared cash on NPC towers placed on pre-set pads along the track, then upgrade them down branching paths. Kill a husk and it splits into smaller, faster husks, so killing things is only half the job — you have to kill the debris too.

Placement is walk-up, not top-down. You run to a pad in normal third-person, a shop opens, you buy. This is the single biggest scope saver in the document: pre-set pads mean no free-placement validation, no navmesh recalculation, and no camera system to build. It also mirrors BTD6's fixed placement spots, so nothing about the strategy is lost.

WHY THIS GENRE

Tower defense is a top-tier Roblox category (Anime Vanguard, Tower Defense Simulator) with no polished equivalent on Fortnite's discovery charts, which are saturated with box fights, zone wars, deathruns and droppers. The existing Fortnite TD maps are rough and nobody owns the category.

Your weapon is the hero.

There is no separate hero system. You pick a weapon type, that weapon grants its own ability, and it levels on two tracks at once: one that resets every match, and one that never does.

In BTDD the hero is a slot you fill and then ignore — it levels automatically and you can't spend on it. Collapsing the hero into the weapon fixes that. Your weapon choice now decides your stats, your ability, and what you're working toward across every session you ever play.

The three weapon types

WEAPON TYPE	ABILITY	WHAT IT DOES	ROLE
Precision	Mark	Paint one enemy. It takes +50% damage from every source for 8 seconds, and the mark carries down through its splits.	Boss deleter
Sustained	Overdrive	For 10 seconds your fire rate doubles and every tower near you gains +40% fire rate.	Force multiplier
Ordnance	Airburst	Mortar strike on a marked stretch of track: heavy area damage plus a 2 second stun.	Panic button

Abilities unlock at tier 2 of their path, which makes the crossover rule interesting: a player who crosses into a second path gets that ability too, but permanently stuck at its weakest form. Commit for power, split for flexibility.

TRACK ONE

In-round tiers

- Bought with the same shared cash as towers
- Resets to zero every match
- Five tiers per weapon type
- Max one path fully; second path caps at tier 2

TRACK TWO

Weapon mastery

- Bought with Storm Cores, earned by playing
- Saved forever, per weapon type
- Twenty levels per weapon type
- Head starts and unlocks, never raw damage

In-round: what you buy during a match

TIER	PRECISION	SUSTAINED	ORDNANCE	COST
1	Scoped pistol	SMG	Shotgun	300
2	Marksman rifle	Assault rifle	Grenade launcher	700
3	Heavy marksman	Heavy AR	Twin launcher	1,600
4	Anti-materiel rifle	LMG	Mortar	3,500
5	Railgun — pierces a lane	Minigun — no reload	Rocket launcher — wide splash	8,000

Trade-offs by type: Precision has huge single-target damage and is useless against swarms. Sustained shreds crowds and is stopped cold by armor. Ordnance has the best clear in the game and cannot hit air at all.

Game-wide: what you keep forever

Storm Cores are awarded per round survived, scaling with round number, so a loss at round 27 still pays out meaningfully. Cores are spent on mastery levels for a specific weapon type, which means committing to Precision across many sessions is itself a choice.

MASTERY	UNLOCK	WHY IT'S A HOOK
1–4	–5% per level on this weapon's in-round upgrade costs	Immediate, visible, small
5	Ability cooldown –15%	First real power spike
10	Start every match at tier 1, and unlock a second ability variant you pick at match start	Changes how you open a match, and gives the weapon a second identity
15	Ability cooldown –30%, and the ability gains a secondary effect	Mark also slows; Overdrive also reloads towers; Airburst also knocks back
20	Mastery skin, and the crossover cap rises to tier 3 for this weapon only	A rules change, not a stat. The strongest possible reward

Show mastery level next to each player's name in co-op. A visible badge other people can see is worth more retention than any number on a spreadsheet.

TWO BALANCE RISKS, STATED UP FRONT

The player out-damaging their own towers. If that happens this stops being a tower defense and becomes a horde shooter with decorations. Three levers keep it honest: weapon damage scales sub-linearly with cost, a player can only physically cover one stretch of track at a time, and late rounds run multiple spawn lanes so nobody can be everywhere. Test at round 25 specifically — if one player standing still clears it with no towers bought, the numbers are wrong.

Mastery breaking the difficulty curve. This is why mastery gives cost reductions, cooldowns, head starts and unlocks, and never damage multipliers. A level 20 player and a level 1 player have to be able to play the same co-op match without either one being dead weight or trivializing it.

Five towers, three paths each.

Each tower is an NPC Character Definition: a Fortnite outfit, a weapon, a team index, and a custom Verse behavior. Upgrading swaps the definition, so the skin visibly changes as it powers up.

Pick outfits from whatever the NPC roster actually offers in-editor — the archetype matters more than the specific skin. What matters is that the five read as instantly different silhouettes at a glance from across the map.

Scout 200 CHEAP SINGLE-TARGET DPS

Fast SMG fire, short range, low damage. The tower you spam early and never fully stop buying.

Can hit air.

RANGE

Wider detection, then covers an entire track segment regardless of distance.

RATE

Faster fire, then dual-wield for double output at close range.

DAMAGE

Heavier rounds, then armor-piercing — the cheap answer to Armored Husks.

Sniper 350 GLOBAL RANGE, SLOW

One high-damage shot on a long cooldown, but range covers the whole map. Hits air. Your reach.

PIERCE

Shots pass through a line of husks, then ricochet to a second lane.

SPOTTER

Faster fire, then marks its target so every other tower deals bonus damage to it.

SIEGE

Massive damage to Zeppelin-class only, then a stun on hit.

Grenadier 550 AREA DAMAGE, GROUND ONLY

Splash damage that hits clusters. Cannot target air at all, which is the whole reason Drifter Llamas exist.

BLAST

Larger radius, then a lingering burn field on the track.

CLUSTER

Each shell splits into three smaller blasts. Thematically rhymes with the husks.

CONCUSSIVE

Knocks husks backward along the track, then briefly stuns on every hit.

Chiller 400 SUPPORT / CROWD CONTROL

Almost no damage. Slows everything in a radius. Placed at a corner, it doubles the value of every tower around it.

FIELD

Bigger slow radius, then permanent slow that persists after leaving the zone.

FREEZE

Periodic hard stop on everything in range. Buys you seconds when it matters.

BRITTLE

Chilled husks take +25% damage from all sources, then +50%. The support pick.

Quartermaster 1000 ECONOMY, NO ATTACK

Generates cash at the end of each round. Never shoots anything. The tower that decides whether round 35 is survivable.

YIELD

More cash per round, scaling steeply.
The pure greed option.

AIRDROP

Spawns physical loot chests players must run over to collect. Uses Fortnite instead of fighting it.

LOGISTICS

Towers within range get a discount on upgrades, then sell back at full price.

A sixth tower — a dedicated anti-air Flak — is the obvious first post-launch addition. Leave it out of the first build; Scout and Sniper already cover air.

Everything splits into something worse.

The layer system is what makes *BTD6* feel like *BTD6*. In *UEFN*, NPCs have real health, so the effect comes from low HP plus a spawn-on-death chain in *Verse*.

TIER	ENEMY	HP	SPEED	ON DEATH	NOTES
1	Husk	1	1.0×	—	Baseline
2	Brute Husk	1	1.2×	2 × Husk	—
3	Shielded Husk	2	1.0×	2 × Brute	—
4	Armored Husk	3	0.8×	2 × Shielded	Immune to base Scout
5	Storm Husk	4	1.4×	3 × Armored	Fast and dense
Air	Drifter Llama	4	0.9×	2 × Shielded	Flying — Grenadier can't touch it
Boss	Loot Zeppelin	200	0.5×	4 × Drifter Llama	MOAB-class, bursts into loot
Boss	Storm Barge	700	0.4×	4 × Loot Zeppelin	Round 40 finale

Treat these numbers as a starting point to break, not a spec. The ratios matter more than the values — keep each tier roughly twice the threat of the one below it and tune from there.

Round pacing

- **1–10** — Tiers 1–2 only. Teaching rounds. A player should be able to fail-forward here.
- **11–20** — Armor and the first Drifter Llamas. This is where a pure-Grenadier build gets punished.
- **21–30** — Storm Husks. Density spikes. Slow becomes mandatory.
- **31–40** — Loot Zeppelins, then the Storm Barge at 40.

Forty rounds is the right first target. It's a 25–35 minute session, which is long enough to build an economy and short enough that people finish it.

Shared cash, contested priorities.

Start at **650 cash** and **40 lives**. Cash comes from 1 per layer popped plus a round-end bonus of `100 + round number`. Forty lives rather than a hundred keeps a leak feeling bad, which is what makes the Chiller worth buying.

THE CO-OP PROBLEM NOBODY DESIGNS FOR

Shared cash in a 4-player lobby means one person can drain the pot on their own weapon path while everyone else watches. *BTD6* has this problem too and only half-solves it.

Two fixes worth prototyping: cap each player's spend at a percentage of the pot per round, or split income into per-player wallets plus a shared pot that only funds towers. Build the second one if you have time — it makes the Quartermaster a genuinely social decision.

The two currencies

Cash is in-round and shared. It buys towers, tower upgrades and weapon tiers, and it vanishes when the match ends.

Storm Cores are per-player and permanent. They're awarded at the end of a match based on the highest round reached, whether you won or not, and they only buy weapon mastery levels. Keeping them out of the in-round economy entirely is what stops a veteran's save file from warping a co-op match.

SAVED PER PLAYER	SHAPE
Storm Cores	1 integer
Mastery level × 3 weapon types	3 integers
Ability variant chosen × 3	3 small integers
Highest round reached	1 integer

Eight integers is the entire save file. Tower unlocks derive from highest round reached — towers 3, 4 and 5 unlock at rounds 10, 20 and 30 — so they cost nothing extra to store.

Every system, and the feature behind it.

GAME SYSTEM	UEFN FEATURE
Towers	NPC Spawner device driven by an NPC Character Definition — carries the outfit, cosmetic modifiers, team index and behavior script
Tower behavior	Custom Verse class built from the NPC Behavior template, referenced by the Character Definition
Tower doesn't shoot you	Team index assignment — keep towers and players on the same team
Upgrading a tower	Despawn and respawn with a different Character Definition. Assume this rather than runtime stat edits until you've confirmed otherwise in-editor
The track	Walled geometry with navmesh; enemies path to sequential nav points
Leaks	Volume device at the exit, subtract a life on overlap
Splitting on death	Verse — on elimination, spawn N of the child type at the parent's position
Cash, shop, HUD	Verse UMG for custom UI; track cash in Verse, not the built-in scoring device
Tower pads	Verse-driven placement slots with an interaction trigger opening the shop UI
Player weapon tiers	Verse grants the tier's weapon to the player on purchase and removes the previous one
Weapon abilities	Verse cooldown timer plus a targeting trace for Mark and Airburst; Overdrive is a radius query over nearby tower instances
Mastery levels and Cores	Verse persistable data — eight integers per player, read at match start, written at match end

VERIFY IN-EDITOR BEFORE YOU COMMIT

Whether a spawned NPC's weapon and health can be changed at runtime, or whether you have to despawn and respawn it, decides the shape of your entire upgrade system. Test this in week one. Despawn-respawn is the safe assumption and it's fine — it also gives you a free visual "pop" on upgrade — but knowing for certain changes how you write the tower state machine.

THE HIDDEN SCOPE TRAP

Five towers × three paths × five tiers is up to 75 Character Definitions to author by hand. That will eat your entire schedule.

Only change the *skin* at tiers 3 and 5, not every tier. Intermediate tiers change stats only. That takes you to roughly 15 definitions for the first build, and players still get the satisfying visual jump twice per path.

Prove the loop before you build the game.

These are strictly sequential. Each phase produces something playable, so you always have a thing to test with instead of a half-built system.

1 One tower, one enemy, one track

No cash, no UI, no upgrades. A pre-placed Scout shoots Husks that walk a track, and you lose a life when one gets through. Hardcode everything.

Target: **1 week** · Answers: does UEFN pathing hold up under 40 NPCs at once?

2 Cash, pads, and a shop

Walk to a pad, open a UI, buy a Scout. Cash from kills and round-end. Sell for partial refund. Still one tower type.

Target: **1–2 weeks** · Answers: is walk-up placement actually fun or just tedious?

3 Upgrade paths and splitting

The real system: path state per tower instance, Character Definition swapping, the crossover rule, and the spawn-on-death chain through all five tiers.

Target: **2–3 weeks** · The hardest phase. Everything after this is content.

4 Weapon tiers and abilities

The in-round track only — five tiers per weapon type, the crossover rule, and all three abilities. Leave mastery for phase 6; you cannot balance a permanent progression track against numbers that aren't settled yet.

Target: **1–2 weeks** · Expect to retune every tower after this lands.

5 Fill the roster, build 40 rounds

Remaining four towers, air enemies, Zeppelin and Barge bosses, the full round table. Mostly authoring, not engineering.

Target: **2–3 weeks**

6 Co-op, mastery, publish

Four-player testing, the shared-wallet rules, then the full mastery track and Storm Cores on top of balance you've already settled. Plus a thumbnail that reads at gallery size.

Target: **1–2 weeks** · Publish before it's finished. Discovery rewards updates.

Two people, two lanes.

The clean split is systems versus content. Whoever is more comfortable coding takes Verse; the other owns the editor and the spreadsheet. Don't both try to write Verse — you'll collide constantly on shared state.

LANE A — VERSE

Systems

- Wave manager and round table
- Economy, wallets, round-end payouts
- Tower state machine and path crossover rules
- Spawn-on-death splitting chain
- Shop and HUD in Verse UMG
- Weapon tier grants and ability cooldowns
- Persistable data: Cores, mastery, unlocks

LANE B — EDITOR

Content

- Track layout, navmesh, tower pad placement
- Every NPC Character Definition and its outfit
- Enemy tier configuration
- The balance spreadsheet — single source of truth
- VFX and audio for hits, splits, leaks
- Lighting and readability from the play position
- Thumbnail, title, and discovery description

ONE RULE THAT WILL SAVE YOU A FIGHT

All numbers live in the spreadsheet, and Verse reads them from a single constants file that Lane B owns. The moment balance values are scattered through behavior scripts, only one of you can tune the game.

09 — STAYING UN-DELISTED

Clone the systems, not the expression.

Game mechanics aren't protected. Specific creative expression is. The difference is what keeps this published.

You can freely copy the structure: fixed track, layered splitting enemies, three upgrade paths with a crossover limit, an economy tower, a hero. None of that is anyone's property.

What will get you pulled

- Monkeys. Balloons. Anything that reads as a bloon.
- Borrowed names — MOAB, BFB, Bloonarius, Dart Monkey, Tack Shooter, Glue Gunner, or BTDD's exact upgrade names.
- Recreating BTDD's actual track layouts or copying its icon art.
- **Putting "Bloons" or "BTDD" in your map title, description or tags.** This is how clones actually get found and delisted — not by someone playing them, but by a keyword search.

What keeps you clear

- Fortnite-native fiction throughout: storm husks, loot llamas, Zeppelins.
- Your own tower names, your own upgrade names, your own numbers.

- A genuine mechanical difference — which the weapon mastery system already gives you. Lead with it in your description.

Check Epic's Fortnite Creative content and IP guidelines before publishing. The bar is whether a reasonable person would think it's an official Bloons product, and Fortnite characters shooting storm husks clears that easily.

Storm Split · design and build plan v1 · numbers are starting points,
not specs